THE SELFISH GENE

Richard Dawkins was Charles Simonyi Professor for the Public Understanding of Science at Oxford University from 1995 to 2008. Born in Nairobi of British parents, he was educated at Oxford and did his doctorate under the Nobel Prize-winning ethologist Niko Tinbergen. From 1967 to 1969 he was an Assistant Professor at the University of California at Berkeley, returning as University Lecturer and later Reader in Zoology at New College, Oxford, before becoming the first holder of the Simonyi Chair. He is an Emeritus Fellow of New College.

The Selfish Gene (1976; second edition 1989) catapulted Richard Dawkins to fame, and remains his most famous and widely read work. It was followed by a string of bestselling books: *The Extended Phenotype* (1982), *The Blind Watchmaker* (1986), *River Out of Eden* (1995), *Climbing Mount Improbable* (1996), *Unweaving the Rainbow* (1998), *A Devil's Chaplain* (2003), *The Ancestor's Tale* (2004), *The God Delusion* (2006), and *The Greatest Show on Earth* (2009). He has also published a science book for children, *The Magic of Reality* (2011), and two volumes of memoirs, *An Appetite for Wonder* (2013) and *Brief Candle in the Dark* (2015). Dawkins is a Fellow of both the Royal Society and the Royal Society of Literature. He is the recipient of numerous honours and awards, including the 1987 Royal Society of Literature Award, the *Los Angeles Times* Literary Prize of the same year, the 1990 Michael Faraday Award of the Royal Society, the 1994 Nakayama Prize, the 1997 International Cosmos Prize for Achievement in Human Science, the Kistler Prize in 2001, and the Shakespeare Prize in 2005, the 2006 Lewis Thomas Prize for Writing About Science, and the Nierenberg Prize for Science in the Public Interest in 2009.